



Competitive Intelligence

Strategic Management

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Competitive Intelligence Programs

Competitive intelligence (C I)

- A systematic and ethical process for gathering and analyzing information about the competition's activities and general business trends to further a business's own goals.

Obtaining Competitive Intelligence

Legal and ethical ways to obtain competitive intelligence:

- Reverse-engineer rival firms' products.
- Use surveys and interviews of customers, suppliers, and distributors of rival firms.
- Analyze rival firm's Form 10-K.
- Conduct fly-over and drive-by visits to rival firm operations.
- Search online databases.
- Contact government agencies for public information about rival firms.

Obtaining Competitive Intelligence

Legal and ethical ways to
obtain competitive
intelligence:

- Monitor relevant trade publications, magazines, and newspapers.
- Purchase social-media data about customers of all firms in the industry.
- Hire top executives from rival firms.